

HEATHER LI

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EDUCATION

The London School of Economics

September 2025 - August 2026

MSc International Relations (Research)

Predicted: Distinction

- 10,000-word thesis supervised by Dr Shikha Dilawri using archival methods and discourse analysis to study environmental violence in international law.
- PhD-level methodology training, including Qualitative Text and Discourse Analysis.

University of Oxford

October 2021 - June 2025

BA (Hons) in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics

First-Class Honours

- Awarded the Gibbs Prize for Best Overall Performance in Politics. Ranked 9th out of 228 candidates (top 4%).
- 15,000-word thesis (79) supervised by Professor Louise Fawcett and Weishen Zeng, applying critical discourse analysis to archival material on global environmental hierarchy in international environmental agreements.
- Quantitative training in econometrics and quantitative economics; College book prizes for first-class performance in Quantitative Economics and Microeconomics (2023, 2024).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Ditchley Foundation

June 2026 - August 2026

Research Intern

- Produced briefs on political and policy issues for senior leadership, delivered as slide decks and written notes.
- Conducted open-source desk research to map networks of prospective participants, informing how each was approached.
- Piloted Gemini AI as a tool for open-source research, contributing to an internal assessment of its reliability.
- Supported conference programming at a foundation convening senior figures on peace, freedom and the rule of law.

Department of International Relations, the LSE

March 2026 - May 2026

Research Assistant

- Assisted Dr Sinja Graf with qualitative coding and textual analysis for a project examining the politics of UNESCO World Heritage Sites.
- Surveyed over 266 content pages and hand-coded themes and patterns between various pages in Excel, including flagging country-level and criterion-level differences.
- Employed R packages such as tidyverse to effectively present the data.

G20 Research Group, University of Toronto

July 2024 - December 2024

Research Compliance Analyst

- Qualitatively coded national compliance against standardised criteria, applying an agreed depth-and-breadth framework consistently across 43 commitments and 20 countries.
- Researched and synthesised evidence of compliance from a diverse range of sources, including World Bank/IMF meeting minutes, bilateral meetings, and report sponsorship.
- Produced background research supporting in-person teams reporting and negotiating at the G20 Rio Summit.

Department of Politics and International Relations, Oxford September 2024 - October 2024
Research Assistant

- Applied qualitative content analysis to code open-ended survey responses from US participants, capturing sentiment on hypothetical global governance arrangements.
- Worked within a team of coders to maintain consistency across English, Portuguese, Japanese and German responses, agreeing how to treat contextual and linguistic differences.
- Supported Dr Farsan Ghassim's book on public opinion towards international organisations and global democracy.

Conference of Defence Associations Institute (CDAI) June 2024 - September 2024
Research Assistant

- Developed interview questions and conducted in-depth interviews with senior figures, including Canada's Parliamentary Budget Officer, Yves Giroux, and former Assistant Deputy Minister of Materiel Alan Williams.
- Compiled literature reviews summarising defence procurement policy and NATO operations in Canada, drawing on academic and grey literature.
- Authored policy briefs on critical mineral supply chains and international cooperation, using small-n comparative case study analysis of Canada and Australia.
- Returned as rapporteur for the Montreal Climate Security Summit, writing briefs from sessions with military, political and industry participants.
- Supported CDAI outreach to encourage participation of women and gender minorities in security.

Department of Economics, University of Oxford April 2023 - August 2023
Research Assistant

- Coded and tagged the research output of over 30 academics against a shared framework to map the department's policy impact and engagement, identifying strengths and gaps.
- Worked under Professor Alex Teytelboym on the Oxford Policy Engagement Network (OPEN).
- Supported the creation of an Impact & Engagement webpage presenting the findings, currently still in use by the University of Oxford.

SKILLS

Research Skills

- *Qualitative*: Qualitative content analysis and coding to standardised frameworks in Excel; in-depth interviews with senior stakeholders; interview transcript analysis; survey data coding; critical discourse analysis of legal documents and historical archives.
- *Quantitative*: R (advanced); intermediate econometrics; analysis of large datasets; data visualisation. MATLAB (intermediate).

Other Skills

- *Languages*: English (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Proficient), French (Intermediate, B2).
- *Technical*: MS Office, including Excel and PowerPoint; Squarespace, WordPress, NationBuilder; HTML/CSS.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

The Oxford Union October 2022 - December 2023
Convenor & Chair

- Convened two debating tournaments, one with over 1,500 participants, managing a £45,000 budget and a team of eight.